

FX Technical Update

A hot payrolls print keeps the dollar rally in gear despite overbought momentum and sentiment conditions

- EUR/USD revisits the 1.0202 Sep 2022 61.8% retrace after rejecting key short-term resistance near 1.045 and on the heels of a hot payrolls report. A break lower would turn our attention to the 1.009 Nov 2022 pattern breakout.
- Cable pressures the 1.2225-1.2299 resistance layer. Even if an oversold bounce develops, medium-term bears keep control while below the 1.2486-1.2609 key cluster of resistance levels. The next major support levels sit near 1.20, then in the 1.18-handles.
- The USD/JPY rally stays in gear after pushing through the 156.75-157.23 resistance layer, but shows material trend deceleration that implies fatigue and an increased chance for mean reversion. Key medium-term trend support rests at 152.69-154.404.

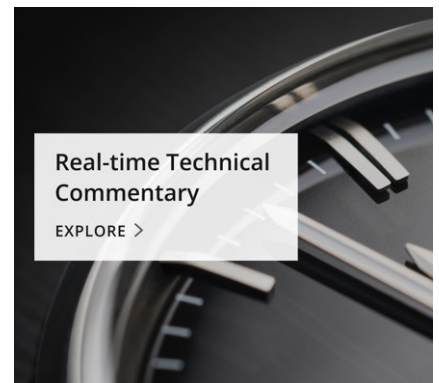
Technical Strategy

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EUR/USD keeps the 1.02 support layer under pressure after rejecting key resistance near 1.045

EUR/USD bearish trend momentum stays firmly in gear after the early-Jan rejection of key short-term resistance at the 1.045 mid-Dec tactical breakdown area and on the heels of a hot US labor data release. The pair is revisiting the 1.0202 Sep 2022 61.8% Fibonacci retracement level that was first tested at the start of the year (Figure 1). Oversold short-term momentum and sentiment conditions along with bullish momentum divergence signals on the daily time frame have only led to very brief mean reversions to higher prices since the trend started in Oct and as market expectations concerning the US election outcome started to materially shift. That dynamic that points squarely at a trend regime in technical analysis terms stays intact until we see trend deceleration on lower frequency time frames (weekly and potentially monthly) or the market breaks through a key resistance zone. From our perspective, we would point to the 1.045 area as that key resistance for the health of the bear trend. Given the conditions, we suspect a breakout could lead to a rapid squeeze to medium-term resistance in the mid-1.06s. In our view, that zone will likely cap the pair in the months ahead even if a short-term position squeeze derails the current trend dynamics. Conversely, a break below 1.02 would turn our attention to the next support that includes the 1.009 Nov 2022 pattern breakout and then the 0.9909 Sep 2022 78.6% retrace. Longer-term levels are clustered at 0.9537-0.9675.

Figure 1: EUR/USD revisits the 1.0202 Sep 2022 61.8% retrace after rejecting key short-term resistance near 1.045 and on the heels of a hot payrolls report. A break lower would turn our attention to the 1.009 Nov 2022 pattern breakout.

EUR/USD, weekly bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

GBP/USD bearishly pressures the 1.2225-1.2299 support layer

Cable stays under pressure and pressures the 1.2225-1.2299 support layer that includes the Apr 2024 low, Sep 2022 38.2% retrace, and Sep-Dec .618 swing objective (Figure 2). The pair has been pressed into some degree of oversold territory on the daily time frame since late Oct and has now reached oversold territory on the weekly time frame. Like the EUR/USD dynamics discussed above, the short-term oversold conditions and tactical buy signals that have triggered in recent weeks have only led to very short-term mean reversions to higher levels. Until we see a clear base pattern develop, we suspect short-term rebounds that develop in the first quarter will represent more of the same. Tactically, look to the 1.2380 Jan 2 low as resistance. Key levels for the short-term trend dynamics now sit at 1.2486-1.2609, which include the early-Jan breakdown, Sep channel, other intraday chart pivots, and most importantly the Mar 2023 internal trend line. Even if the market sees further consolidation over the near term via the oversold momentum and sentiment conditions, we would look for further weakness in the months ahead as long as the pair respects that key resistance zone. To the downside, the next major support levels rest at the 1.2037 Oct 2023 low and then a large cluster of levels in the 1.18-handles.

Figure 2: Cable pressures the 1.2225-1.2299 resistance layer. Even if an oversold bounce develops, medium-term bears keep control while below the 1.2486-1.2609 key cluster of resistance levels. The next major support levels sit near 1.20, then in the 1.18-handles.

GBP/USD, weekly bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

The USD/JPY rally stays intact but shows material deceleration

USD/JPY keeps the rally going after the late-year break through the 156.75 Nov high and 157.23 Jul 78.6% retrace, but at the same time, the early-year price action shows material trend deceleration and triggered a couple of our momentum divergence sell signals (Figure 3). In Dec, we highlighted the bearish risk on the 10-year JGBs chart with that market pressuring the 1.10-1.14% multi-month range support. The subsequent break through that area has seen JGBs and other DM bonds keep pace with and at times outpace the UST backup. The next major support for JGBs sits another 5-10bp cheaper than current levels. Continued weakness there can stand in the way of a re-acceleration to higher USD/JPY levels. Tactically, the USD/JPY bull trend needs to hold above the 155.95-156.24 recent range lows to stay on track. A downside break would turn our attention to the cluster of medium-term trend support at 152.69-154.404. That includes the 50-day and 200-day moving average, and Sep-Nov channel trend line. Look for that to hold if the market corrects over the near term. To the upside, next resistance rests at the 159.265 Sep-Dec .618 swing objective, with more significant longer-term resistance not until the low-160s.

Figure 3: The USD/JPY rally stays in gear after pushing through the 156.75-157.23 resistance layer, but shows material trend deceleration that implies fatigue and an increased chance for mean reversion. Key medium-term trend support rests at 152.69-154.404.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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